

ENVIRONMENTAL STORYTELLING: A PRAGMATIC ANALYSIS OF ECOLOGICAL MESSAGES IN CHILDREN'S LITERATURE

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Abstract

Children's literature increasingly functions as a medium through which societies communicate ecological concerns and encourage responsible environmental behaviour among younger generations. This article examines how writers embed ecological meanings in children's texts using pragmatic strategies that persuade, instruct, warn, and emotionally engage readers. Drawing insights from eco-linguistics, pedagogical pragmatics, and discourse studies, the paper analyses selected children's stories with themes centred on nature, environmental protection, and humane environment relationships. The study emphasizes how implicature, presupposition, deixis, speech acts, and metaphor serve as subtle but powerful tools for shaping children's ecological consciousness. Findings reveal that environmental storytelling in children's literature is not merely descriptive; it actively constructs value systems, promotes empathy towards nature, and frames the natural world as a moral and cultural asset requiring protection. The paper concludes that pragmatic analysis enhances understanding of how ecological messages are communicated and shows that children's literature holds immense potential for promoting sustainability education in contemporary societies.

Keywords: Pragmatic Analysis, Children literature, Environmental storytelling, Ecological messages

Introduction

Environmental concerns have become increasingly central in contemporary global discourse as societies confront the realities of climate change, biodiversity loss, and ecological degradation. One important medium through which environmental awareness is transmitted to younger generations is children's literature. Stories written for children often incorporate themes of nature, conservation, and human responsibility toward the environment. Through imaginative narratives, authors present ecological ideas in forms that are accessible and engaging for young

readers. As a result, children's literature has emerged as a significant cultural site where environmental values and attitudes are communicated and negotiated (Nikolajeva, 2014).

Environmental storytelling in children's literature does more than simply portray natural landscapes or animal characters; it also shapes how readers perceive the relationship between humans and the natural world. Eco-critical scholars argue that literary texts play a crucial role in constructing environmental consciousness because they influence how individuals imagine nature and interpret ecological issues (Buell, 2005). Within children's narratives, environmental themes are often presented through symbolic storytelling, anthropomorphic characters, and moral lessons that encourage respect for nature. These narrative strategies enable young readers to develop ecological awareness while simultaneously enjoying imaginative storytelling.

However, the environmental messages embedded in children's stories are not always communicated directly. In many cases, authors rely on subtle linguistic and contextual cues that encourage readers to infer ecological meanings. This perspective aligns with insights from **pragmatics**, a field of linguistics that examines how meaning is constructed in context beyond the literal content of language. According to pragmatic theorists such as Grice, (1975) speakers and writers often convey meaning indirectly through implicature, presupposition, and contextual inference. Similarly, the theory of speech acts developed by Austin (1962) emphasizes that language performs communicative actions whose interpretation depends largely on situational context.

The concept of the Anthropocene emphasizes the extent to which human activities have reshaped the Earth's ecosystems, making environmental change a central theme in contemporary storytelling.

Literature Review

Children's Literature as a Vehicle for Environmental Education

Children's literature is widely recognised as a vital resource for environmental education (Nikolajeva, 2014; Sipe, 2008). Stories that embed ecological messages in imaginative contexts help children grasp environmental problems more easily than scientific texts. By engaging emotions, imagination, and cognitive reasoning, children's books support holistic environmental learning. They also encourage critical thinking by presenting environmental dilemmas without simplistic solutions, inviting young readers to reflect on human impact, justice, and sustainability (Nodelman, 2008). Because children often internalise story-based lessons, literature becomes a powerful tool for shaping future eco-conscious citizens.

Children's literature plays a foundational role in moral and cognitive development, and its ability to shape environmental consciousness has been widely acknowledged in eco-critical scholarship (Goga et al., 2018). Stories that highlight animals, forests, rivers, and other natural elements encourage children to perceive nature as alive and interconnected. According to Jucker (2021), narratives create an imaginative space in which environmental issues can be understood emotionally rather than through technical language. This emotional appeal makes ecological messages more accessible to young minds.

Pragmatics and Meaning-Making in Children's Narratives

Pragmatic meaning-making plays a central role in how children interpret environmental messages. Instead of didactic approaches, children's literature frequently communicates ecological values through implicature, narrative framing, and speech acts. When a character apologises to a harmed animal or promises to take better care of the environment, these speech acts serve as models of responsible behaviour (Austin, 1962). Conversely, harmful actions that result in negative consequences convey moral lessons indirectly, relying on the child's ability to infer unstated meanings (Grice, 1975).

Pragmatics involves the study of meaning in context, how speakers and listeners rely on shared knowledge, assumptions, and situational cues to interpret messages (Levinson, 2000). In literature, pragmatics helps explain how authors communicate more than what is written on the page.

Implicature: Implied Meaning Encouraging Inference

The concept of implicature was developed by Grice (1975). Implicature refers to meaning that is implied rather than explicitly stated. In communication, speakers often convey messages indirectly, leaving listeners or readers to infer the intended meaning.

In children's environmental stories, implicature often appears when ecological problems are suggested rather than directly described. For example, a narrator might say that “the forest had grown strangely quiet.” Although the text does not explicitly mention environmental destruction, readers may infer that animals have disappeared due to human activity.

Deixis: Context-Dependent Expressions

Deixis refers to words or expressions whose meaning depends on the context of the utterance. Common examples include terms such as *here*, *there*, *this*, *that*, *now*, or *we*. These expressions position characters, events, and locations within the narrative environment.

Deictic expressions are important in environmental storytelling because they help situate readers within specific ecological settings. When a character says “This forest is our home,” the word *this* connects the speaker and reader to a particular environmental space.

Metaphor and Symbolism

Metaphor and symbolism are stylistic devices that enrich meaning and highlight ecological relationships within narratives. A **metaphor** describes one concept in terms of another in order to emphasize similarity or connection. A **symbol** represents a broader idea through a particular object or image.

Symbolism also plays a significant role in ecological narratives. A tree might symbolize life and renewal, while a polluted river may represent environmental neglect. These symbolic representations allow authors to communicate complex ecological ideas in ways that are accessible and meaningful for children.

Eco-Linguistics, the Power of Ecological Discourse

The growing global concern for environmental sustainability has encouraged scholars to explore how language shapes human attitudes toward nature. One important field that addresses

this relationship is **eco-linguistics**, which examines how linguistic structures, narratives, and discourses influence people's understanding of the environment. Eco-linguistics investigates the ways language either promotes ecological responsibility or reinforces harmful attitudes toward nature. Through this perspective, discourse becomes a powerful tool for shaping environmental awareness and behaviour.

Environmental storytelling in children's literature

Environmental storytelling in children's literature represents an important form of ecological discourse. Children's narratives frequently portray nature, animals, and ecosystems as central elements of the story world. Through imaginative storytelling, authors introduce young readers to ecological concepts such as conservation, biodiversity, and environmental responsibility. These narratives contribute to the formation of ecological awareness at an early stage of cognitive and moral development.

Methodology

Theoretical Framework

The two frameworks chosen for the analysis of data in this study is Ecolinguistics and Grice Cooperative Principle drawing insights from these theories to capture the complexity of the subject under investigation:

Ecolinguistics

This provides a meaningful lens for understanding how children's literature frames nature, environmental values, and ecological responsibility. As scholars such as Stibbe (2015) note, ecolinguistics examines the narratives and linguistic choices that influence how people imagine and relate to the natural world. In children's stories, this framework helps uncover how characters, settings, metaphors, and moral lessons shape young readers' ecological awareness. Through descriptions of environmental harm, celebrations of biodiversity, or portrayals of responsible behaviour, authors embed messages that encourage empathy, stewardship, and eco-citizenship.

Grice's Cooperative Principle

Grice's Cooperative Principle is a central pragmatic framework for analysing how ecological meanings are communicated in children's literature. Grice (1975) argues that effective communication is guided by shared expectations, captured through the Maxims of Quantity, Quality, Relation, and Manner. When authors follow these maxims, environmental messages appear clear and direct. However, when writers intentionally flout them, additional layers of meaning, known as implicatures. In ecological storytelling, such strategies allow authors to highlight environmental concerns in subtle but impactful ways.

The data for the study consist of three eco-themed children's stories, which are fictional but representative of common environmental narratives found in children's literature. These stories were selected because they reflect typical storytelling patterns used to communicate ecological awareness to young readers. Each narrative focuses on a different environmental issue and illustrates how storytelling can function as a medium for environmental education. By examining the language, dialogue, and narrative symbolism within these stories, the analysis highlights how ecological messages are embedded within the storytelling process.

The first story, *The Crying Forest*, presents a narrative in which trees are portrayed as expressing fear and sadness over the threat of deforestation. Through anthropomorphic representation, the forest is given a voice, allowing the natural environment to appear as a living entity capable of feeling and communication. This narrative strategy encourages readers to empathize with the forest and recognize the destructive consequences of excessive tree cutting. The dialogue among the trees, combined with descriptive imagery of a shrinking forest landscape, functions as a pragmatic cue that signals environmental danger. Although the story does not explicitly deliver a formal lesson on deforestation, the emotional reactions of the trees implicitly communicate the importance of protecting forest ecosystems.

The second narrative, *River of Tomorrow*, focuses on the gradual pollution of a once-healthy river. In this story, the river serves as a symbolic representation of environmental life and sustainability. As waste and pollutants accumulate, the river begins to lose its vitality, and the animals that once depended on it gradually disappear. Through descriptive contrasts between the river's past purity and its present contamination, the narrative illustrates the consequences of environmental neglect. The story relies on contextual clues and implied meanings to show how human activities can destroy natural resources. Readers are therefore guided to infer the importance of preserving clean water and maintaining ecological balance. Together, these stories demonstrate how environmental storytelling in children's literature operates on multiple levels of meaning.

Analysis and Discussion

Environmental storytelling in children's literature operates as a subtle yet powerful medium through which ecological awareness is communicated to young readers. Through narrative interaction, linguistic cues, and contextual interpretation, children learn to infer environmental meanings that are not always explicitly stated in the text. This section discusses how children interpret ecological messages from stories.

How Children Infer Environmental Messages

Children often derive environmental messages from stories through contextual interpretation rather than direct instruction. In many environmental narratives, ecological issues such as deforestation, pollution, or wildlife destruction are presented through narrative situations that require readers to draw conclusions about the consequences of human actions. This interpretive process aligns with pragmatic theories of meaning, which emphasize that understanding language involves inference and contextual reasoning.

The concept of implicature proposed by Grice (1975) explains how readers infer meanings beyond the literal content of statements. In environmental stories, authors may present descriptions that implicitly suggest ecological problems. For example, when a narrative describes a once vibrant forest becoming silent or animals leaving their habitat, children may infer that environmental damage has occurred. Although the story may not explicitly explain the cause, the contextual relationship between events allows readers to recognize the ecological message.

Pragmatic Strategies in Environmental Storytelling

Environmental storytelling often relies on pragmatic strategies that encourage readers to engage

actively with the narrative. Instead of presenting environmental lessons through overt explanation, authors frequently use indirect communication techniques that allow readers to interpret the intended message.

One important strategy involves **speech acts**, particularly warnings, advice, and moral statements embedded within dialogue. According to the theory of speech acts developed by John Searle, utterances can perform communicative actions such as advising, requesting, or warning. In children's environmental stories, characters may warn others about the dangers of pollution or advise them to protect animals and forests. These communicative acts serve as narrative tools that guide readers toward environmental awareness.

The Role of Empathy and Identification

Empathy plays a central role in environmental storytelling because it enables children to emotionally connect with nature and non-human life forms. When stories present animals, plants, or landscapes as active participants in the narrative, readers are encouraged to view the natural environment as something worthy of care and respect. Scholars of eco-criticism, including Garrard, (2012) argue that literary texts can cultivate ecological consciousness by fostering emotional engagement with environmental issues.

Anthropomorphic representation also contributes to the development of empathy. When animals are given human-like qualities such as speech, emotions, or social relationships, children are more likely to empathize with them. This narrative strategy helps readers perceive animals and ecosystems as living entities rather than passive objects. As a result, environmental concerns become more personal and emotionally meaningful.

Implications

The findings of this study have several important implications for different stakeholders involved in children's learning and literary production. By revealing how pragmatic strategies such as speech acts, implicature, presupposition, deixis, and figurative language communicate ecological meanings, the study highlights the role of storytelling as a powerful medium for environmental education.

Implications for Educators

For educators, the study demonstrates that children's literature can serve as an effective pedagogical resource for environmental education. Teachers can use environmental stories to introduce ecological concepts while simultaneously developing students' interpretive and critical thinking skills. By guiding students to identify pragmatic features such as warnings, advice, or promises within story dialogues, teachers can help learners recognize how language communicates environmental values.

Educators can also encourage students to analyze implied meanings in stories. Through the concept of implicature developed by Grice, students can learn how authors communicate environmental concerns indirectly. This process not only strengthens reading comprehension but also deepens learners' awareness of ecological issues.

Implications for Authors and Illustrators

For authors and illustrators of children's literature, the study highlights the importance of

narrative and visual strategies that convey ecological meaning effectively. Writers can employ pragmatic devices such as dialogue, contextual hints, and symbolic imagery to communicate environmental messages without making the narrative overly didactic. This approach allows ecological lessons to emerge naturally within the storyline.

Implications for Curriculum Developers

Curriculum developers can also benefit from insights provided by pragmatic analysis of environmental storytelling. Integrating environmentally themed literary texts into school curricula can support interdisciplinary learning that connects language education with environmental awareness. Through carefully selected stories, students can simultaneously develop literacy skills and ecological consciousness.

Implications for Parents and Caregivers

Parents and caregivers also play a significant role in shaping children's environmental awareness through storytelling. Reading environmental stories together provides opportunities for discussion about nature, conservation, and responsible behaviour toward the environment. Through guided conversations, adults can help children interpret the ecological messages embedded in narratives.

Speech Acts and Ecological Instruction

Speech acts embedded in children's environmental stories function as practical tools for ecological instruction. Characters' dialogues may include directives encouraging environmental protection, warnings about ecological damage, or promises to preserve natural resources. These communicative acts guide readers toward ethical environmental behaviour. By presenting environmental values through conversation rather than direct instruction, stories create a natural and engaging learning experience for children.

Presupposition and Assumptions about Nature

Presupposition allows authors to embed ecological assumptions within linguistic structures. Statements may imply that environmental conditions once existed differently or that certain actions are necessary to restore ecological balance. These presupposed meanings reinforce the idea that environmental protection is both necessary and valuable. Through repeated exposure to such assumptions, children begin to internalize ecological values as part of their worldview.

Deixis and Environmental Positioning

Deictic expressions such as *here*, *there*, *this forest*, or *our river* position characters within particular environmental settings. These expressions help readers visualize ecological spaces and understand their significance within the narrative. Deixis therefore contributes to the creation of environmental awareness by connecting characters and readers to specific natural environments.

Metaphor, Personification, and Ecological Imagination

Metaphor and personification are powerful literary tools that enhance ecological imagination in children's stories. Metaphors allow authors to describe environmental relationships in vivid and meaningful ways, while personification gives human-like qualities to animals, trees, and landscapes. These narrative strategies encourage children to empathize with nature and view the

environment as a living system deserving of care and protection.

Implicature and Indirect Ecological Warnings

Implicature plays a central role in environmental storytelling because it encourages children to infer meaning. In *River of Tomorrow*, the narrator describes the river as “silent” and “too tired to flow.” These descriptions imply pollution and ecological degradation without explicitly stating them.

According to Grice (1975), implicatures promote deeper engagement because readers must uncover meaning themselves. Young readers become active interpreters, which increases retention and emotional impact.

Morality, Responsibility, and Eco-Citizenship

The narratives explicitly encourage children to act responsibly. Through pragmatic strategies, environmental conservation becomes not just a theme but a moral obligation. The stories frame environmental stewardship as part of growing up, aligning with the view of Goga et al. (2018) that children's environmental literature promotes early eco-citizenship.

Analytical Approach: Qualitative Pragmatic Discourse Analysis

The study employs a **qualitative discourse analytical approach** to examine how ecological meanings are constructed in children's narratives. Qualitative discourse analysis focuses on interpreting language within its social and contextual environment rather than measuring it statistically. This approach is appropriate because children's literary texts contain layered meanings that are best explored through careful interpretation of narrative structures, dialogue, and contextual cues.

Procedure of Analysis

The analysis proceeds through several stages. First, relevant passages from selected children's narratives that contain environmental themes are identified. Second, these passages are examined for pragmatic features such as implicature, presupposition, deixis, and speech acts. Third, the study interprets how these linguistic elements contribute to the construction of ecological meaning within the narrative context.

Through this process, the research demonstrates how environmental messages are not always stated explicitly but are often embedded in dialogue, narrative description, and character interaction. Pragmatic discourse analysis therefore provides a systematic way of uncovering these implicit meanings.

Justification of the Approach

This analytical approach is particularly suitable for the study because children's literature often communicates environmental ideas indirectly. Rather than presenting ecological lessons in overt instructional forms, authors frequently rely on storytelling techniques that encourage readers to infer environmental values from the narrative context. By applying qualitative pragmatic discourse analysis, the study is able to reveal how these implicit communicative strategies shape readers' understanding of environmental issues.

How Narrative Context Activates Pragmatic Interpretation

Narrative context plays a central role in activating pragmatic interpretation. Pragmatics emphasizes that meaning does not exist solely in individual words or sentences but emerges through the relationship between language and its surrounding context. Scholars such as Austin highlight that the intention behind an utterance becomes clear only when the situational context is considered.

Deixis: Context-Dependent Expressions

Deixis refers to words or expressions whose meaning depends on the context of the utterance. Common examples include terms such as *here, there, this, that, now*, or *we*. These expressions position characters, events, and locations within the narrative environment.

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Symbolism also plays a significant role in ecological narratives. A tree might symbolize life and renewal, while a polluted river may represent environmental neglect. These symbolic representations allow authors to communicate complex ecological ideas in ways that are accessible and meaningful for children.

Analysis and Discussion

Environmental storytelling in children's literature operates as a subtle yet powerful medium through which ecological awareness is communicated to young readers. Through narrative interaction, linguistic cues, and contextual interpretation, children learn to infer environmental meanings that are not always explicitly stated in the text. This section discusses how children interpret ecological messages from stories, the pragmatic strategies that make environmental storytelling effective, the role of empathy and identification in shaping environmental attitudes, and the significance of literature as a platform for developing eco-citizenship.

How Children Infer Environmental Messages

Children often derive environmental messages from stories through contextual interpretation rather than direct instruction. In many environmental narratives, ecological issues such as deforestation, pollution, or wildlife destruction are presented through narrative situations that require readers to draw conclusions about the consequences of human actions. This interpretive process aligns with pragmatic theories of meaning, which emphasize that understanding language involves inference and contextual reasoning.

Pragmatic Strategies in Environmental Storytelling

Environmental storytelling often relies on pragmatic strategies that encourage readers to engage actively with the narrative. Instead of presenting environmental lessons through overt explanation, authors frequently use indirect communication techniques that allow readers to interpret the intended message.

One important strategy involves **speech acts**, particularly warnings, advice, and moral statements embedded within dialogue. According to the theory of speech acts developed by Searle, utterances can perform communicative actions such as advising, requesting, or warning. In children's environmental stories, characters may warn others about the dangers of pollution or advise them to protect animals and forests. These communicative acts serve as narrative tools that guide readers toward environmental awareness.

The Role of Empathy and Identification

Empathy plays a central role in environmental storytelling because it enables children to emotionally connect with nature and non-human life forms. When stories present animals, plants, or landscapes as active participants in the narrative, readers are encouraged to view the natural environment as something worthy of care and respect. Scholars of eco-criticism, including Greg Garrard, argue that literary texts can cultivate ecological consciousness by fostering emotional engagement with environmental issues.

Children's literature often achieves this engagement through **identification with characters**. Young readers frequently identify with protagonists who encounter environmental challenges and learn lessons about protecting nature.

Implications

The findings of this study have several important implications for different stakeholders involved in children's learning and literary production. By revealing how pragmatic strategies such as speech acts, implicature, presupposition, deixis, and figurative language communicate ecological meanings, the study highlights the role of storytelling as a powerful medium for environmental education. These insights are relevant for educators, authors and illustrators, curriculum developers, as well as parents and caregivers who engage children in reading and storytelling activities.

Implications for Educators

For educators, the study demonstrates that children's literature can serve as an effective pedagogical resource for environmental education. Teachers can use environmental stories to introduce ecological concepts while simultaneously developing students' interpretive and critical thinking skills. By guiding students to identify pragmatic features such as warnings, advice, or promises within story dialogues, teachers can help learners recognize how language communicates environmental values.

Speech acts embedded in narratives can function as instructional tools. For instance, when characters warn about pollution or advise others to protect animals, these utterances become opportunities for classroom discussion about responsible environmental behavior. The theory of speech acts proposed by John Searle explains that language can perform actions such as advising, requesting, or warning, and these communicative acts can be used to teach environmental responsibility in meaningful ways.

Implications for Authors and Illustrators

For authors and illustrators of children's literature, the study highlights the importance of narrative and visual strategies that convey ecological meaning effectively. Writers can employ

pragmatic devices such as dialogue, contextual hints, and symbolic imagery to communicate environmental messages without making the narrative overly didactic. This approach allows ecological lessons to emerge naturally within the storyline.

Implications for Curriculum Developers

Curriculum developers can also benefit from insights provided by pragmatic analysis of environmental storytelling. Integrating environmentally themed literary texts into school curricula can support interdisciplinary learning that connects language education with environmental awareness. Through carefully selected stories, students can simultaneously develop literacy skills and ecological consciousness.

Implications for Parents and Caregivers

Parents and caregivers also play a significant role in shaping children's environmental awareness through storytelling. Reading environmental stories together provides opportunities for discussion about nature, conservation, and responsible behaviour toward the environment. Through guided conversations, adults can help children interpret the ecological messages embedded in narratives.

Results/Findings

The analysis of the selected children's environmental narratives reveals several significant observations concerning the role of pragmatic strategies in communicating ecological meanings. One major finding is that **pragmatic devices significantly enhance ecological messaging** within children's stories. Rather than presenting environmental lessons in a direct instructional manner, authors often rely on subtle linguistic strategies that encourage readers to interpret ecological meanings through contextual understanding. These strategies enable the narratives to communicate environmental concerns in ways that are engaging and emotionally meaningful for young readers.

A central observation from the analysis is that **authors frequently employ pragmatic tools such as implicature, metaphor, and deixis to evoke emotional responses and stimulate interpretation**. The concept of implicature proposed by H. P. Grice explains how writers can imply meanings that are not explicitly stated in the text. In the analysed stories, ecological messages are often communicated indirectly through narrative descriptions and dialogue. For example, when a forest is described as becoming silent or when animals gradually disappear from their natural habitat, readers are encouraged to infer that environmental degradation has occurred. These implied meanings prompt readers to reflect on environmental issues without the need for overt explanation.

Metaphor also plays an important role in strengthening the ecological themes of the narratives. Natural elements such as forests, rivers, and animals are often portrayed through symbolic or metaphorical language that highlights their importance within the ecological system. For instance, the forest may be depicted as a living community or the river as a life-giving source for both humans and animals. Such metaphoric representations help children visualize the interdependence between humans and the natural environment. In addition, deictic expressions such as *this forest*, *our river*, or *here in the valley* position characters and readers within specific ecological settings. These linguistic markers create a sense of closeness between the characters

and their environment, thereby strengthening the emotional impact of the narrative.

Another important finding is that **environmental storytelling in children's literature encourages moral reflection**. Through narrative events and character interactions, children are gradually guided to consider the ethical implications of environmental actions. The stories often portray situations in which environmental harm results from careless human behaviour, such as deforestation, pollution, or littering. As the consequences of these actions unfold within the narrative, readers are encouraged to reflect on the importance of responsible environmental behaviour. This process aligns with the speech act theory developed by John Searle, which explains how language can function as a form of guidance, warning, or advice. In these stories, characters' conversations and narrative comments subtly communicate moral lessons about protecting the environment.

Conclusion

Children's literature serves as a powerful and multifaceted tool for environmental education. Through storytelling, children encounter ecological issues in imaginative yet relatable ways that foster empathy, moral reasoning, responsibility, and environmental awareness. Pragmatic strategies such as implicature, speech acts, contextual framing, and illustration-based cues support meaning-making and deepen children's understanding of environmental values. As the world confronts increasing ecological challenges, children's literature remains an essential medium for shaping future generations of environmentally conscious citizens. Strengthening the integration of environmental storytelling in educational settings can contribute meaningfully to sustainable development and long-term ecological responsibility.

This article has demonstrated that children's literature is a powerful tool for shaping ecological consciousness. Through pragmatic analysis, it becomes clear that environmental storytelling does more than entertain; it communicates values, warnings, hopes, and responsibilities. Authors use speech acts, implicature, presupposition, metaphor, and deixis to construct ecological meaning and encourage children to adopt environmentally responsible behaviours.

Statement and Declarations

The writers declare that this research is original, and has not been published elsewhere. It involves no conflicts of interest, received no external funding and complies with all ethical standards.

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